

images from other images.

GD was originally known as 'GIF Draw'.

However, since the revoking of the Unisys licence, it has informally stood for 'Graphics Draw'. GD can create images composed of lines, arcs, text (using dynamic fonts), other images, and multiple colours. Version 2.0 adds support for true colour images, alpha channels, resampling (for smooth resizing of true colour images), and many other features. GD supports numerous programming languages including C, PHP, Perl, Python, Ocaml, Tcl, Lua, Pascal, GNU Octave, REXX, Ruby and Go.

Installing GD on the WAMP stack (Windows)

On the Windows platform, *php_gd2.dll* should be included in a standard PHP installation, but it is not enabled by default.

To enable it, simply uncomment the *extension=php_gd2.dll* line in your *php.ini* file by removing the # character from the beginning of that line. After this step, the WAMP server has to be restarted to enable the PHP extension.

Installing GD on the LAMP stack (Linux)

To install using Fedora, type:

```
$ yum install php-gd
```

To install using Red Hat Enterprise Linux or CentOS, type:

```
$ up2date php-gd
```

```
$ service httpd restart
```

For Debian/Ubuntu, type:

```
$ sudo apt-get install php5-gd
```

Verifying PHP-GD support in an existing installation

Option 1

Type the following command at a shell prompt:

```
$ php5 -m | grep -i gd
```

The sample output is:

```
$ gd
```



Figure 1: Verifying PHP extensions

Option 2

```
$ php5 -i | grep -i --color gd
```

Option 3

```
$ php -i | grep -i --color gd
```

The output is:

```
Additional .ini files parsed => /etc/php5/cli/conf.d/gd.ini,
gd
GD Support => enabled
GD Version => XXXX
```

Option 4

1. Create a file *phptest.php* in the Web server directory.
 - In Linux -> Apache DocumentRoot (such as */var/www*)
 - In Windows -> Apache DocumentRoot (such as */wamp/www*)
2. Copy the following code in *phptest.php*:

```
<?php
phpinfo();
?>
```

3. Open a Web browser and point it to *http://ServerIPAddress/phptest.php*
It will display all the parameters and loaded extensions.

Creating a rectangle with text in PHP GD

Using PHP GD functions, a dynamic image can be created with ease. The method of creating a PNG image is described below.

In the first line of code, the header specifies the content type. For a JPG or GIF image, this line will change accordingly. After this line, we have to use the